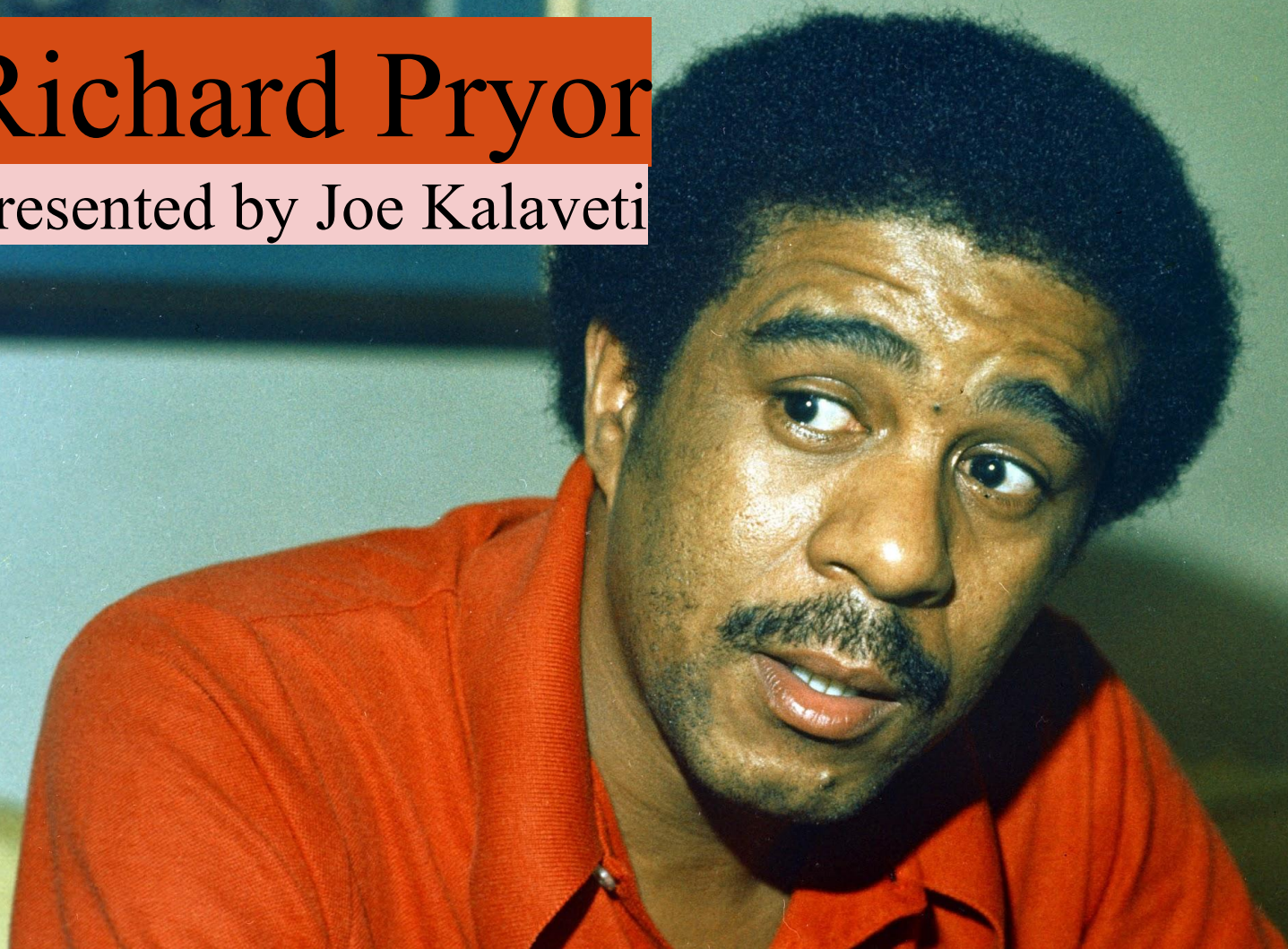


Richard Pryor

Presented by Joe Kalaveti



Richard Pryor:

Introduction



**Actor, Screenwriter, film director, comedian, and
television producer**

1940-2005

Early life

- Pryor was one of four children raised in his grandmother's brothel.
- He was sexually abused at age seven, and expelled from school at the age of 14
- After Gertrude abandoned him when he was 10, Pryor was raised primarily by Marie, a tall violent woman who would beat him for any eccentricity
- Richard Pryor was born on December 1, 1940, in Peoria, Illinois. His full name was Richard Franklin Lennox Thomas Pryor, and his early life was marked by hardship and complexity.



Family

- He was married seven times
- He married two woman twice, including his widow jennifer Lee-Pryor
- His final marriage to jennifer Lee-pryor was his longest, lasting from 2001 until his death in 2005
- Pryor's relatives on his paternal side made their living in the underground economy for at least three generations before him.
- He was close to his grandmother, marie and his father, Buck
- Pryor also had a stepmother named Ann



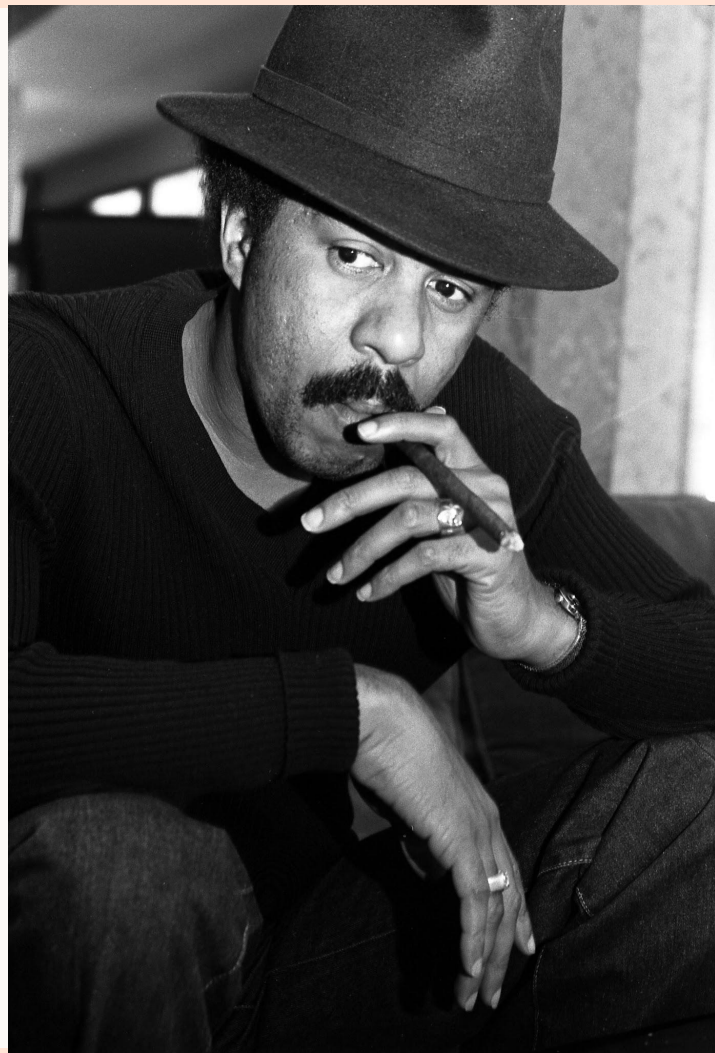
Cultural context

- Richard Pryor was the first african american artist to candidly comment on social inequities before an integrated audience.
- In tackling racial issue, politics and details of his personal life.
- Pryor managed to be bitinglly funny, edgy, controversial and yet not be threatening to white audience



Career

- Richard Pryor had a groundbreaking career as a stand-up comedian, actor, writer, and producer.
- He rose to fame with his fearless and often controversial comedy, tackling subjects like race, addiction, and social issues with brutal honesty and unmatched storytelling.
- He got sick for a time period which was the downfall of his performing career



Civil rights and social justice

- Richard Pryor used his comedy to confront racism, police brutality, and social injustice, giving voice to the Black American experience.
- Through sharp, honest humor, he challenged both Black and white audiences to face uncomfortable truths about systemic inequality.
- Pryor also explored the power of language and identity, evolving over time in his views. His fearless approach to social commentary paved the way for future comedians to blend activism with entertainment.
- Richard Pryor, one of the most influential comedians of the 20th century, played a significant role in advancing conversations around civil rights and social justice, especially through his comedy.





Richard Pryor talks about making a movie in prison, murderers, and racist groups.

Wondering what other hobbies is Mr.Pryor also famous for?

- Pryor loved animals so much that he became an animal rights advocate. He loved animal and supported organizations like PETA.
- He had an appreciation for music, especially jazz and blues. He even incorporated musical elements into some of his performances and admired musicians like Miles Davis
- Watching movies



The end...



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